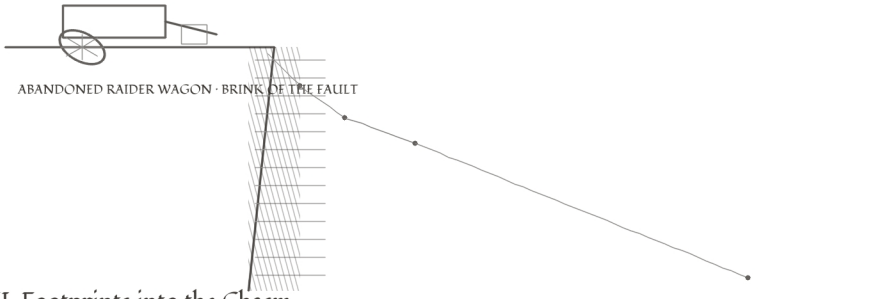
Brink of the Great Fault

The Abandoned Wagons & Descent into the Subterranean Gorge

I. The Smashed Axles

~~At the absolute edge of~~ the northern plateau, where the ground falls vertically three hundred paces into the canyon floor, we found their transport carts. Two heavy baggage wagons, their hickory axles split in two, abandoned amid shattered packing crates. They could haul their stolen plunder no further on wheels.



II. Footprints into the Chasm

~~From the wreckage, heavy~~ booted tracks lead down the scree slope into the Whispering Chasm. The raiders carried the brass Astrolabe by hand, cradled in coarse burlap, descending into the dark gorge where no wagon or beast can follow. Hermes and I have tightened our packs; the highland trek is concluded.

III. The Southern Gate Awaits

~~Look across the gulf, Silvia:~~ Sheet 13B and 14A form the great subterranean floor of the desert. Beyond the acoustic maze of the canyon lies the Desert Oasis and Tower II. Step boldly down the scree.